Thank You for Your Purchase!

I hope you find the template and tutorial helpful! If you have any questions or feedback, I'd love to hear from you.

My slab-building system is simple: cut, score, slip, and join. That's it. With this technique you can build almost anything, from mugs to vases.

Feel free to reach out via email at fran@fromfran.com or send me a message on Instagram @from_fran. If you create something with this template, tag me - I love seeing your work!

Looking for more? Explore my other pottery templates and guides for even more ways to bring your ideas to life.

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happy making!

xoxo Fran

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What You'll Need



Clay



Vinegar



Bucket w/ water



Wire clay cutter



Canvas



Angle cutter tool



Wood modeling tool



Rib tool



Scoring tool



Brush



Sponge



Pillow foam



Wood sticks



Rolling pin

optional



Cookie cutters



Extruder



Balsa wood



Wood base

Before You Begin & Intel

Printing Guidelines

All the templates can be printed at 100% scale, but remember that they work at any scale. You can size up or down in your printer settings to make your handles larger or smaller depending on your preference.

SHRINKAGE?

Different clay bodies shrink at different rates (typically 10-15%). Use the Pottery Template Shrinkage Calculator if your clay is in a different range.

MAGIC SLIP

Use a mix of vinegar with water and clay dust for a magic slip that works like glue. Specially great for when you have to fix hairline cracks.

The Three Essential Parts

The templates include 3 parts:

- Body
- Base
- Handle

Assembly Process

The slab-building sequence moves from forming the *Body* to adding the *Bottom*, then attaching *Handle*. This same sequence technique can be used for building any of my designs, from simple mugs to more complex forms.

Clay Moisture

If your clay feels too wet and sticky, lay it on your canvas for a few minutes. The canvas will absorb some of the excess moisture, making the clay easier to work with. Just be careful not to let it dry out too much.

Scale and Shrinkage

- Print at 100% scale or scale up or down depending on your preference
- You can also use the template generator included for exact measurements

Template Preparation

- Use high-quality, printable paper
- Print template at full size
- Carefully cut out each template piece
- Optional: Laminate for repeated use or trace onto balsa wood
- Optional: Cookie cutters are great for cutting bases and/or handles

Clay Preparation Tips

- Recommended clay thickness: 3-5mm (1/8 - 1/4 inch)
- Roll clay on canvas or smooth surface
- Flip and turn many times if your slab is too thick
- Use consistent pressure when rolling for even thickness
- If clay is too wet, let it rest 10-15 minutes after rolling for optimal workability

Cutting Guidelines

- Place template on rolled clay
- Use craft knife to trace around template
- Cut smoothly and steadily
- Remove excess clay carefully
- Store excess clay in a bag and use in other project



Mix & Match Handle System

All handle designs in this bundle are fully interchangeable with any cup body template. This modular approach gives you complete creative freedom to customize your pottery projects:

- Pair a ring handle with an espresso cup for a modern look
- Add a half-moon handle to your latte mug for a contemporary feel
- Use the loop handle with a tall mug for a classic appearance

The attachment technique remains the same regardless of which handle-body combination you choose. Simply score, slip, and attach using the methods demonstrated in the handle sections. This versatility allows you to create a cohesive collection with varied styles or experiment with different looks before committing to a design.

Slab Making Step by Step



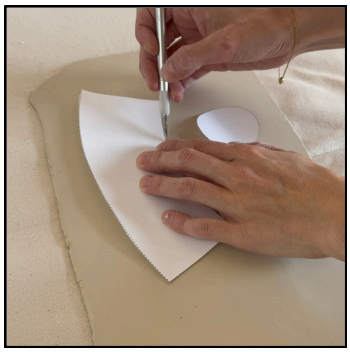
Roll

Roll out your clay into an even slab using a rolling pin.



Compress

Use a rib tool to compress and smooth the clay surface.



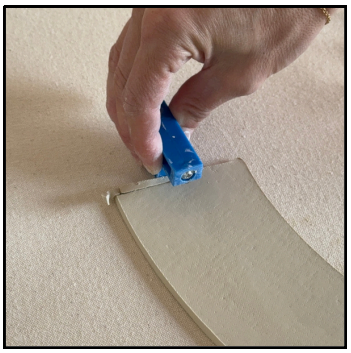
Cut

Cut the slab to your desired shape using a template.



⋆.˚ Tip ⋆.˚

Transfer the template to a balsa wood shape and use cookie cutters.



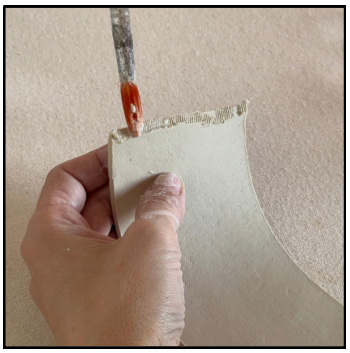
Cut

Cut both edges using an angle cutter tool. Remember to flip and turn after cutting the first edge.



Score

Create texture on both edges.



Brush slip

Apply slip (vinegar) to the scored areas.



Curve and press

Curve the clay into a cylinder shape and firmly press scored and slipped edges together.



Smooth

Smooth the interior with a wooden tool.



Flip

Turn the piece over carefully to work on the other side.



Score

Create texture on the base.



Brush slip

Apply slip to the newly scored area.



Add bottom

Attach the circular base to create the bottom.



Nice!

Check your work and assess overall shape.



Flip and join

Turn and connect the base to the body.



Join

Secure all connections. Push the clay of the base into the body.



Tap

Gently tap , many times, refine connect.



Tap again

Continue refining the form for evenness.



Clean rim

Smooth and refine the top edge with a sponge.



Clean base

Smooth and refine the bottom edge.



Smoth interior

Refine the inside surface with a brush.



Clean handle

Prep the handle area for attachment.



Score handle

Create texture on the handle connection point.



Score body

Create texture on the cup where handle will attach.



Attach

Connect the handle to the cup body.



Smooth

Blend connection points on both sides. Use your wood tool and brush.



Smooth

Use your finger to smooth out any imperfections.



Let Dry

Drying time will depend on your climate and clay thickness – I usually wait about 2 days until they're fully bone dry.



Next steps

Once completely dry, your pieces are ready for bisque firing. After the bisque firing, you can glaze them as you wish.

Ring Handle



Roll

Roll a small coil of clay for the handle.



Extruder

Use an extruder for consistent thickness.



Push

Gently push the coil out of the extruder. Smooth out with your finger if there are imperfections.



Score

Create texture on connection points.



Brush slip

Apply slip to the scored areas.



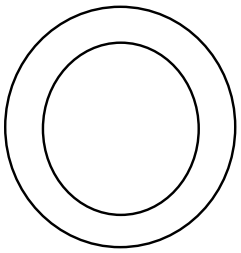
Press

Form the clay into a ring shape.



Attach to body

Connect the ring handle to the cup.



ring handle

Half-Moon Handle



Cut

Cut a circle from a slab of clay.



Cut in half

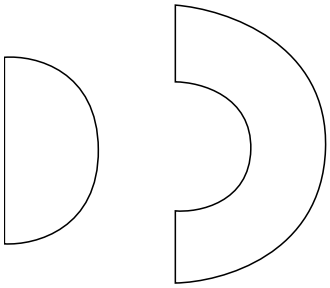
Create a half-moon shape.



Attach to body

Connect to the cup body with scoring and slip.

half-moon



regular

Regular Handle



Cut

Cut a circle from a slab of clay.



Cut in half

Create a half-moon shape. Cut a smaller circle inside. Or cut a donut shape and then cut in half.



Attach to body

Connect to the cup body with scoring and slip.

Loop Handle



Angle cut

Cut the loop handle shape with angled ends. Remember to flip and turn after you cut the first angle.



Score

Create texture on both ends.



Brush slip

Apply slip to the scored areas.



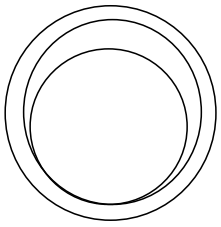
Press

Curve the clay into a circle.

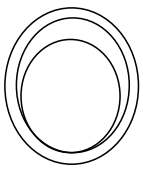


Attach

Connect to the cup with scoring and slip.



loop
medium



loop
small

Wavy Handle



Shape 1

Cut the wavy handle shape and manually form a wavy shaped handle.



Shape 2 and dry

Use a straight ruler or wood to guide the edges while it's drying to leather hard state.



Score

Create texture on both ends.



Score

(Detail of the score on both ends).



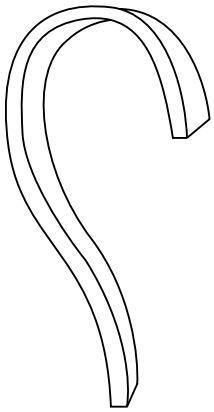
Attach

Connect to the cup with scoring and slip.



Attach

Connect to the cup with scoring and slip.



wavy handle

Wavy Plate Step-by-Step



Roll

Roll out your clay into an even slab using a rolling pin.



Compress

Use a rib tool to compress and smooth the clay surface.



Cut

Cut the slab using a cake or cookie cuter or use the Bread & Butter Template.



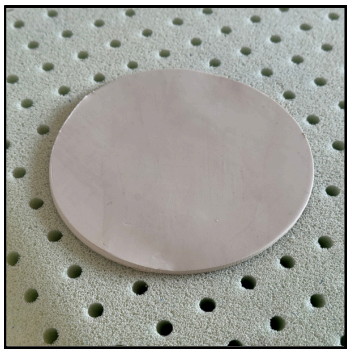
Cut

Cut around the template.



Remove

Remove excess clay from around your circle.



Foam

Place a piece of foam on your work surface.



Wood Base

Position your wooden base in the center of the clay circle



Push

Gently press the wooden base down into the clay.



Ta-da

Apply even pressure until you achieve your desired ruffle effect.

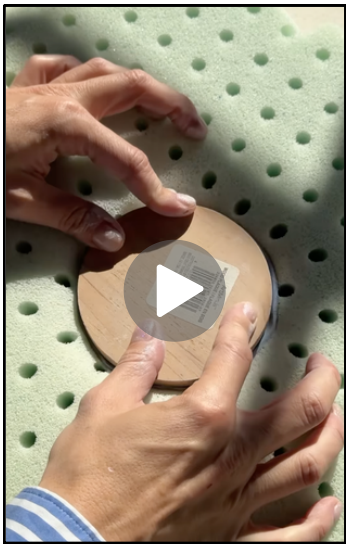
Video Demos

From crafting perfect saucers to mastering half-moon espresso cups, my Instagram @from_fran and YouTube is your go-to pottery tutorial hub.

Learn, create, and transform clay into art – one short demo at a time.

Questions about the templates or clay techniques?

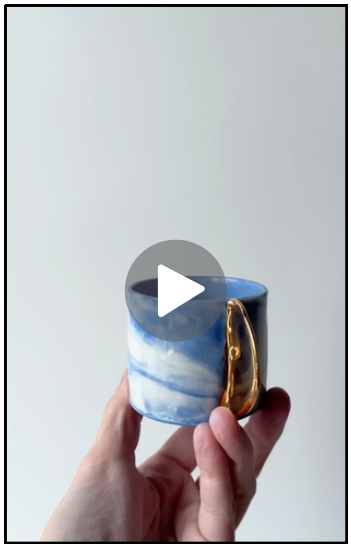
I'm here to help! Drop me a line at fran@fromfran.com



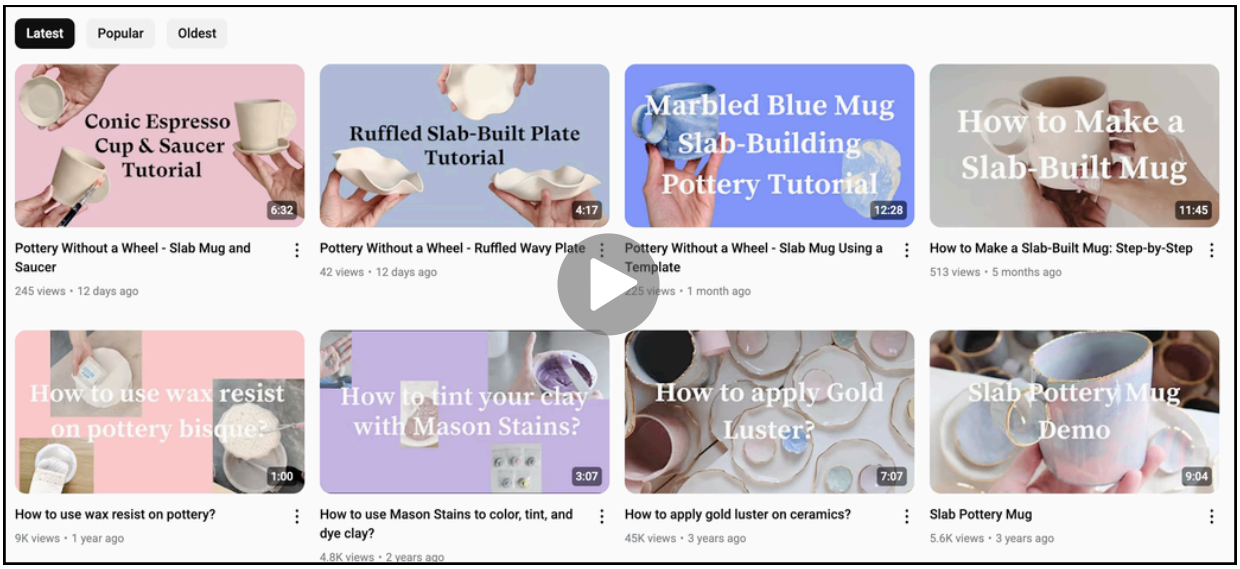
From Slab to Plate



From Slab to Mug



From Slab to Espresso



Pottery Template Shrinkage Calculator

Create simple pottery templates with just a few clicks. Ideal for ceramicists of all levels.

Click here

